Your Power Is Showing: Concept, Voice Guide and Detailed Outline

Book 2 of the "Showing" series · Prepared for Mijke · For your review

This document is the editorial blueprint for Book 2. It defines the book's focus, its reader and its promise, how its voice relates to Book 1, and exactly what each chapter will contain, including the end-of-chapter exercises and the word plan for the manuscript. It also shows, chapter by chapter, how Book 2 complements *Your Insecurity Is Showing* without repeating it.

It is a plan, not the manuscript. Where your own experience could strengthen a chapter, you'll find a short **Your story (optional)** note. These are invitations, not requirements: the book works without them, and nothing personal will be written in your name unless you provide it.

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1. Concept and positioning

The central problem

Book 1 ends with a woman who has stopped letting insecurity make her decisions. That's a real achievement, but it leaves an honest question: *now what?*

Not shrinking is not the same as growing. Many women who are no longer apologising, over-explaining or chasing approval still find their lives running on **default**: the job they drifted into, the salary they accepted, the friendships that happen out of habit, the relationship that "just happened", the business idea filed under "someday". Nothing is wrong, exactly. It's all *fine*. And "fine" has quietly become the new comfort zone.

The problem Book 2 tackles is not fear; it's **drift**. Most of her important choices are made in the moment, under pressure, by whoever or whatever is loudest. Power, in this book, means something specific and practical: **deciding on purpose, before the moment decides for you, and following through.**

> ***The core idea:*** *Power isn't a personality. It's a decision you make before the moment arrives.*

The ideal reader

She is roughly 20 to 35. She may have read Book 1, or she may start here. She is not necessarily anxious or insecure; she's capable, often busy, and quietly frustrated. She knows what she *won't* put up with any more, but she's less sure what she actually wants. She has ambitions she plays down, money conversations she avoids, and a sense that she's living below her own potential without knowing exactly where to start.

She'll recognise herself in moments like these:

- In her performance review she says "I'm happy where I am" because she hasn't worked out what she'd ask for.
- She has a business, creative or study idea that has been "for next year" for three years.
- She accepted the first salary offer, or prices her freelance work low "because she's still new".
- She avoids opening her banking app at the end of the month.
- A colleague presents an idea she shared in a meeting last week, and she says nothing.
- She dates whoever shows interest, and only later asks herself whether she even liked them.
- Her long-term partner, her family or an old friend still treats her according to an arrangement from years ago.

- Her group chat is mostly complaining, and nobody in her life is doing what she wants to do.
- She starts every January with a big goal and has quietly dropped it by March.

The promise and the realistic change

The promise: By the end of the book the reader will know what she wants, will have written down her own standards, and will have practical systems for building ambition, money confidence, visibility and relationships that reflect those standards.

What the book does not promise: It doesn't promise wealth, a promotion, a perfect partner or a life without setbacks. Outcomes depend on many things outside her control. The realistic change is this: **more of her life will be chosen rather than defaulted into.** She'll ask for things she used to hope for, make decisions in advance instead of in a panic, keep going after the excitement fades, and surround herself with people who raise the bar rather than lower it.

What makes this book different

1. **It starts where most empowerment books stop.** Many books help women stop doing things: stop people-pleasing, stop comparing, stop settling. Book 2 is about what to *build* in the space that leaves.
2. **Its own signature tool: the Pre-Decision.** Book 1 taught the reader to catch insecure behaviour as it happens. Book 2 works earlier: before the salary meeting, the date, the family visit or the big week. The four steps (Want, Line, Move, Review) give her a decision made calmly in advance, so she isn't negotiating with herself under pressure.
3. **Standards, not wish lists.** "Standards" is a word women hear constantly online, usually about dating and usually about other people. This book treats standards as concrete, written commitments that apply to her own behaviour first, and covers work, money, time, friendships and family, not only romance.
4. **Ambition and money without hustle culture.** It speaks directly about ambition, negotiation and money, which many books for this audience avoid, without glamorising exhaustion, wealth or "boss" clichés, and without giving financial advice.
5. **The same voice, a different energy.** The tone is still direct, challenging and funny, but where Book 1 held up a mirror, Book 2 hands over the plan and says "go".
6. **It stands on its own.** A reader who starts here gets everything she needs. A reader who comes from Book 1 meets new tools, not a repeat.

Title and subtitle

Working title: *Your Power Is Showing*

Recommended subtitle: *Raise Your Standards, Own Your Ambition, and Take Up Space on Purpose*

It names the book's three main areas (standards, ambition, presence) and carries over the series idea from the research ("take up space, on purpose"). It also mirrors the rhythm of the Book 1 subtitle, which helps the two covers read as a pair.

Alternatives for consideration:

- *Stop Settling, Start Choosing, and Build a Life You Don't Have to Explain*
- *A No-Fluff Guide to Standards, Ambition and Asking for What You Want*
- *How to Stop Living on Default and Start Deciding on Purpose*

Concept presentation (for the book's pitch)

> *You stopped shrinking. Good. Now what? Your Power Is Showing is the bold, funny and practical next step for women who are done settling for "fine". It's about the part nobody teaches: deciding what you actually want, setting standards you live by, asking for the money, taking credit for your work, choosing who you date instead of waiting to be chosen, and building a circle that pulls you forward. In the voice of a big sister who believes you're capable of more and won't let you pretend otherwise, the book replaces drift with deliberate choices made before the pressure hits. Power isn't a personality. It's a decision. This book shows you how to make it.*

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2. Voice guide for Book 2

Same voice, different energy

Both books share one voice: **a big sister who notices everything, says it out loud, makes you laugh about it, and then helps you act on it.** Book 2 keeps the same four qualities and the same guardrails as Book 1. What changes is the energy:

	Book 1: *Your Insecurity Is Showing*	Book 2: *Your Power Is Showing*
Main stance	The mirror: "Look at what you're doing."	The coach: "Here's the plan. Go."
Humour aimed at	Insecure habits: over-apologising, screenshotting, decoding texts	Drift and false modesty: the "someday" file, "I'm not a money person", "it would be nice if…", coasting on "fine"
Typical challenge	"Why are you doing this?"	"What exactly do you want, and what's stopping you from asking?"
Emotional goal	Relief and recognition	Momentum and pride
Typical exercise	Notice, count and interrupt a habit	Decide in advance, ask, build, make visible

The four qualities in Book 2

Quality	What it means on the page	What it must not become
Direct	Gets to the point; names numbers, deadlines and exact words to say.	Bossy or prescriptive about what her life "should" look like.
Challenging	Questions comfortable stories: "I'm fine where I am", "good work speaks for itself", "I'm just not ambitious".	Pushy, or implying that every woman must want a big career, more money or a relationship.
Witty	Finds the comedy in drift, false modesty and the elaborate ways we avoid asking.	Mocking the reader's current job, income, relationship status or choices.
Empowering	Every challenge comes with a concrete method, script or system. Treats the reader as capable.	Hype, "boss" clichés, or promises of wealth and success.

The rhythm of a section: Call it, Get it, Build it

Book 1 sections followed *Call it, Get it, Change it*. Book 2 keeps the same structure with a forward-looking last beat:

1. **Call it.** A scene or habit of drift the reader recognises, told with humour.
2. **Get it.** Why it happens: the scripts, fears or practical obstacles behind it, explained without blame.

3. **Build it.** The method, script, standard or system that replaces the drift.

Guardrails specific to Book 2

Book 2 follows every guardrail of Book 1 (no body shaming, no stereotypes about women, no diagnoses, no invented facts, no borrowed voice, inclusive dating language). In addition:

- **Ambition comes in many shapes.** Ambition can mean a career, a business, a craft, study, a family, a community or a body of creative work. The book never ranks these or implies that a corporate career is the "real" kind.
- **No hustle culture.** No glorifying exhaustion, early-morning routines as moral tests, or "rest when you're dead" energy. Rest is part of discipline, not its opposite.
- **No wealth flexing and no financial advice.** The money chapter covers confidence, conversations, negotiation and knowing your numbers. It gives no investment, tax or debt advice, and recommends a qualified professional for those questions. Examples work for readers on very different incomes.
- **Respect real constraints.** Money, health, caring responsibilities, visas, location and discrimination are real limits. The message is "choose deliberately within your reality, and push the edges where you can", never "if you haven't got it, you didn't want it enough".
- **No "boss babe" or "high-value woman" language.** These phrases carry associations (and online subcultures) that clash with the book's values. Power here isn't about ranking women or being chosen by the "right" man; it's about self-direction.
- **Standards, not entitlement.** Standards are about behaviour and respect, not height, income or status checklists. The book applies them to the reader's own conduct first.
- **No invented data.** Topics like pay gaps or bias against ambitious women are discussed as cultural scripts and lived experiences. No figures are quoted unless they are sourced and checked during writing.

Words and habits

Use	Avoid
Concrete verbs: ask, price, block, send, choose, pitch, decide	Hype words: crush, slay, dominate, level up, unstoppable
"Your standard", "your number", "your next move"	"High-value", "boss babe", "alpha", "queen"
Specific timeframes: "this week", "90 days", "every quarter"	"One day", "eventually", "when the time is right"
"Choose", "decide", "on purpose"	"Manifest", "attract", "the universe will provide"

Voice samples (tone only)

These lines show the intended tone for Book 2. They're calibration examples, not extracts from a chapter.

- "'Someday' isn't a date. Put it in the calendar or admit it's a daydream. Both are allowed. Pretending they're the same thing isn't."
- "'I'm not a money person' is a very expensive thing to believe."
- "You don't need to be fearless to ask for the raise. You need a number, a reason and a sentence that doesn't start with 'sorry'."
- "Motivation is a guest. It's lovely when it visits. Systems are the ones who actually live here."
- "If your calendar disagrees with your values, I'm afraid the calendar is telling the truth."
- "Chemistry tells you who you're drawn to. Standards tell you who gets to stay."
- "Good work doesn't speak for itself. Good work sits quietly in a shared folder while someone else presents it."
- "Being chosen is lovely. Choosing is power."
- "Ambition isn't arrogance. Arrogance is expecting the result without the work. You're doing the work. You're allowed to say what it's for."

Calibration: too harsh, too soft, on voice

	Example
Too harsh	"If you're still underpaid, that's on you."
Too soft	"Money is a sensitive topic, so only ask when it feels right."
On voice	"Nobody is coming to tap you on the shoulder and offer you more. That isn't your fault. Not asking is your choice, though, and it's one you can change this month."

	Example
Too harsh	"Stop wasting your potential."
Too soft	"Everyone moves at their own pace, so there's no rush."
On voice	"There's no deadline on your life. There is, however, a very comfortable sofa called 'next year', and you've been sitting on it for a while."

Your own voice and stories

As with Book 1, the book is written in your first person. Each chapter includes an optional "Your story" prompt. Book 2 deals with topics (money, ambition, relationships) where even a short, real moment adds a lot of credibility. Where you'd rather not share, the chapter uses clearly hypothetical scenarios instead. If you choose a signature touch for

Book 1 (such as a hint of Dutch-style directness, or a recurring way of addressing the reader), it will carry over into Book 2 for consistency.

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3. Book structure at a glance

Book 2 follows a three-part progression that mirrors Book 1: first **decide** what you want and what you'll accept, then **build** it through ambition, discipline and money, then **show** it in how you take up space and in the people you let close.

#	Title	Core topic	Part
Intro	You Stopped Shrinking. Now What?	From "fine" to chosen; the Pre-Decision; the Default Audit	
1	Wanting More Is Not a Character Flaw	Permission to want, and naming it precisely	**Part One: Decide It**
2	Standards Are Not a Wish List	Personal standards across life; the full Pre-Decision	Part One
3	Your Calendar Knows What You Value	Values from evidence; self-respect as daily practice	Part One
4	Ambition Looks Good on You	Ambition in all its shapes; the "someday" file; goals as experiments	**Part Two: Build It**
5	Discipline Is Boring. Do It Anyway.	Systems, routines and environment for long-term goals	Part Two
6	Ask for the Money	Knowing your numbers, money conversations, negotiation, pricing	Part Two
7	Take Up Space on Purpose	Visibility, credit, speaking up, leadership, presence	**Part Three: Show It**
8	Date Like You Have Options (Because You Do)	Choosing partners deliberately	Part Three
9	Standards Don't Expire When You Get Comfortable	Long-term relationships: needs, conflict, renegotiation, repair	Part Three
10	Build a Circle That Raises the Bar	Friendship standards, mentors, sharing power forward	Part Three
Concl.	Let It Show	The Power Plan and the quarterly review	

Why this order

- **Wanting comes first.** Standards, ambition and money all depend on knowing what she wants. Many readers have spent years *not* letting themselves want things specifically, so the book starts by fixing that.
- **Standards before ambition.** Once she knows what she wants, she decides what she'll accept along the way. The Pre-Decision is taught fully in Chapter 2 so every later chapter can use it.
- **Values close Part One** because they test whether her wants and standards are really hers, using evidence from how she actually spends her time and money.
- **Part Two moves from idea to execution to reward:** ambition (what to build), discipline (how to keep building), money (how to be paid for it).

- **Part Three faces outwards.** Visibility comes first because it affects work, dating and friendships alike. Relationships follow in a natural order: choosing someone new, maintaining long relationships, then the wider circle that supports everything else.
- **Bookends mirror Book 1.** Book 1 opens and closes with the Tell Inventory; Book 2 opens and closes with the Default Audit, so readers of both books feel the series structure without repeating an exercise.

Part openers are short divider pages (part title plus one line) and are not counted in the word plan.

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4. Detailed outline

The Pre-Decision: Book 2's signature tool

Introduced in the introduction, taught in full in Chapter 2, and applied in every chapter:

1. **Want.** What do I actually want from this situation? (Not what's polite or likely: what I want. "A 10% raise and one remote day a week.")
2. **Line.** What's the minimum I'll accept, my standard for this situation? ("If the answer is no on both, I'll ask for a clear plan and a review date in writing.")
3. **Move.** What exactly will I say or do? (A short script or action prepared in advance: "Based on X and Y, I'm asking for…")
4. **Review.** Afterwards: did I keep my line? What did I learn, and what will I adjust next time?

How it complements Book 1's Tell Check: the Tell Check works *in or after* the moment, catching a fear-driven habit. The Pre-Decision works *before* the moment, so there's less for fear to grab onto. A reader who knows both has a tool for each side of the moment; a reader who only knows the Pre-Decision still has a complete method.

Format of each chapter

- An opening scene (recognisable, specific, funny).
- Four to six sections following the *Call it, Get it, Build it* rhythm.
- At least one practical tool inside the chapter (script, template, system or worksheet).
- A one-paragraph **The Move** summary stating the chapter's shift in plain words.
- **Power Check:** three questions and one bold, specific move for the week. This mirrors Book 1's Reality Check so the series feels consistent, while signalling the shift from noticing to acting.

Introduction: You Stopped Shrinking. Now What?

Planned length: 2,000 words

Objective and function. Hook both kinds of reader (those coming from Book 1 and those starting here), name the problem of drift, define power in the book's practical sense and introduce the Pre-Decision. This is where she decides the book is for her, not just for women who want a corner office.

Belief to challenge. "Once I stop being insecure, the rest will sort itself out." / "Power is for a different kind of woman."

Sections

1. **The plateau after the breakthrough.** She stopped apologising for everything. She says no. She doesn't screenshot every text. Good. But the job, the salary, the friendships, the weekends and the "someday" plans are still mostly on autopilot. "Fine" has become the new comfort zone.
2. **What power means here.** Not dominance, wealth, followers or a job title. Power is the ability to choose deliberately and follow through. Quiet women, introverted women, women with modest goals and women with huge ones all have access to it.
3. **Decide before the moment does.** Why good intentions fail under pressure: in the moment, old habits and other people's expectations win. The answer is to decide earlier. A short preview of the Pre-Decision (Want, Line, Move, Review) with an everyday example.
4. **If you're starting here.** A short paragraph for new readers: you don't need Book 1 to use this book. One quick, self-contained tip for the moments when old insecure habits still flare up: notice what you just did, name what you were afraid of, and choose a slightly braver next step. Readers who want to go deeper into that can find it in Book 1, but nothing in this book depends on it.
5. **How to use this book.** Three parts (Decide it, Build it, Show it); read in order because the tools build; the Power Checks are where things change. Bold doesn't mean reckless: every move is designed to stretch her without putting her income, safety or wellbeing at risk.
6. **Why I wrote this.** A short personal paragraph from you about why this second book matters. *(See "Your story" below.)*

Everyday situations to develop. The appraisal answer "I'm happy where I am"; the weekend that disappears without a single chosen plan; the travel content saved but never booked; the "we should catch up" that never becomes a date; the January goal that's gone by March.

Tool: The Default Audit. The reader rates eight areas of her life (work, money, love, friendships, family, time and health, home, future plans) on a simple scale from "on default" to "chosen on purpose", with one sentence on why. No judgement; it's a baseline she'll return to in the conclusion.

Takeaway. Power isn't a personality or a status. It's choosing on purpose, and it can be learned.

Link to Chapter 1. Before she can choose deliberately, she has to admit what she actually wants, out loud and in detail. That's harder than it sounds.

Your story (optional). Why you wanted to write a second book; a moment when you realised that "fine" wasn't enough.

PART ONE: DECIDE IT

What you want, and what you'll accept

Chapter 1: Wanting More Is Not a Character Flaw

Planned length: 2,800 words

Objective and function. Give the reader permission, and a method, to want things specifically. Many women are fluent in what they don't want and vague about what they do. This chapter turns "it would be nice if…" into clear, owned wants that the rest of the book can work with.

Belief to challenge. "Wanting more makes me ungrateful, greedy or difficult." / "I should be happy with what I have."

Sections

1. **Grateful and stuck.** Gratitude and ambition are not opposites. "I should be grateful" is often used as a lid: a way to stop wanting before wanting becomes risky. She can appreciate her life and still want more from it.
2. **The "it would be nice" language.** Vague wanting ("It'd be nice to travel more", "Maybe one day I'll do something creative") protects her from disappointment, because nobody can fail at a vague wish. Specific wants feel exposed. The chapter teaches her to say "I want" and finish the sentence.
3. **Where the lid came from.** Common scripts: be modest, don't get above yourself, don't outshine others, don't leave people behind. Family and cultural loyalty, and the fear of outgrowing people she loves. The chapter criticises the scripts, not the families or communities that pass them on.
4. **Borrowed wants and real wants.** Not every want is hers. Some come from her feed, her parents or her peer group. Two tests: Would I still want this if nobody ever knew I had it? Do I want the *process*, not just the result?
5. **From want to direction.** Choosing one to three wants for the next twelve months. Not a vision board: a short, honest list that the rest of the book will turn into standards, plans and moves.

Everyday situations to develop. Saying "I'm fine where I am" in an appraisal; saving travel posts but never booking; going blank when a friend asks "What do you actually want?"; turning a real dream into a joke before anyone else can; applying for something without telling her family.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Unedited Want List:* ten minutes, no crossing out, no "realistic" filter.
- *Borrowed or Mine?* Sorting each want with the two tests above.
- *The "I Want" Sentence:* rewriting each real want without softeners ("maybe", "a bit", "one day").

Takeaway. She's allowed to want more, and she's allowed to say it plainly. A clear want is the starting point for everything else.

Link to Chapter 2. Wants give her direction. Standards decide what she'll accept on the way there.

Your story (optional). Something you wanted and were embarrassed to admit, and what happened when you finally did.

Power Check

1. What do you want that you haven't said out loud to anyone?
2. Which of your goals would you drop if no one could ever see the result?
3. Whose reaction are you protecting when you play down what you want?

This week's move: Say It in One Sentence. Write your most important want as one sentence beginning "I want…", with no "maybe", "a bit" or "one day". Say it out loud to one person you trust this week. Afterwards, note two things: how it felt to say it, and whether their reaction changed how much you want it. (It usually doesn't.)

Chapter 2: Standards Are Not a Wish List

Planned length: 3,000 words

Objective and function. The core chapter of Part One. It defines standards clearly, separates them from preferences and boundaries, helps the reader write her own standards across five areas of life, and teaches the full Pre-Decision.

Belief to challenge. "Having standards makes you difficult or high-maintenance." / "I'll work out my standards when the situation comes up."

Sections

1. **Preferences, boundaries, standards.** A *preference* is what she'd like ("I prefer people who are on time"). A *boundary* is what she won't allow ("If you're more than 30 minutes late without a message, I'll leave"). A *standard* is what she chooses and expects as normal in her life, including from herself ("The people I make plans with respect my time, and so do I"). Boundaries are about refusing; standards are about choosing. Both matter; this book focuses on standards.
2. **High standards, not high maintenance.** Standards apply to her own behaviour first. The difference between standards and perfectionism (impossible), and between standards and entitlement (expecting without giving). Standards are about behaviour and respect, not cosmetic checklists.
3. **Five areas for standards.** How I'm spoken to; how I spend my time; how I'm paid and valued; how I treat myself; the effort and integrity I bring. For each area, examples of concrete standards written as clear sentences, and examples of vague ones that don't work ("I deserve the best").
4. **The Pre-Decision.** The full method (Want, Line, Move, Review) with two worked hypothetical examples: preparing for a salary review, and preparing for a first date. How to write a Pre-Decision in five minutes the day before.
5. **When standards meet reality.** Standards sometimes cost something: a friendship that changes, an opportunity turned down. The difference between *flexing* a standard (a deliberate choice, made calmly and reviewed) and *folding* (dropping it

under pressure in the moment). A standard can change; it just shouldn't change by accident.

Everyday situations to develop. Treating a friend's repeated last-minute cancellations as normal; accepting a job offer on the spot; putting up with a partner's lateness for years; abandoning her own commitments whenever someone else needs something; hearing "that's just how I am" and accepting it as final.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Standards Draft:* one or two sentences for each of the five areas.
- *The Pre-Decision Card:* a simple template she can keep on her phone.
- *Flex or Fold?* Three questions to ask before changing a standard.

Takeaway. Standards are decisions made in advance about how she lives and how she's treated. Written down, they stop being wishes and start being instructions.

Link to Chapter 3. Standards need a foundation: what she actually values. Next, she checks her values against the most honest evidence there is: her own calendar.

Your story (optional). A standard you set that changed a relationship, a job or the way you treat yourself.

Power Check

1. Where in your life are you accepting something as "normal" that you'd never choose on purpose?
2. Which of your standards apply to other people but not to you, or the other way round?
3. Which situation in the next month deserves a decision made in advance?

This week's move: Pre-Decide One Moment. Choose a specific situation coming up in the next seven days: a meeting, a date, a family visit, an invoice, a difficult conversation. The day before, fill in a Pre-Decision Card (Want, Line, Move) and save it on your phone. Afterwards, complete the Review step: did you keep your line, and what will you adjust next time?

Chapter 3: Your Calendar Knows What You Value

Planned length: 2,600 words

Objective and function. Help the reader find her real values from evidence rather than aspiration, and use them as a filter for everyday decisions. This chapter also reframes self-respect as a daily practice: the small, consistent choices that line up with what she says matters.

Belief to challenge. "I already know my values." (When her week says otherwise.) / "Self-respect is a feeling I'll have once things improve."

Sections

1. **Stated values and lived values.** The gap between what she says she values (health, creativity, family, freedom) and where her time, money and attention actually go. Not a reason for guilt; a source of information.
2. **Finding your real values.** Three sources of evidence: what makes her angry (usually a value being crossed); the women she admires, and exactly what she admires in them; and the moments she has felt most like herself. From these, she chooses three or four values and writes her *own* definition for each, because "freedom" means something different to everyone.
3. **Self-respect is a habit, not a mood.** Self-respect shows up in small, repeated choices: keeping her word, how she talks about herself in front of others, protecting time she has set aside for herself, not dropping her plans for someone else's convenience. These choices build the feeling, not the other way round.
4. **The values filter.** A short question to apply to invitations, projects, purchases and commitments: "Does this move me towards what I said matters, or away from it?" Not every decision needs a filter, but recurring ones do.
5. **When values collide.** Real conflicts (ambition and family time, freedom and security) don't have perfect answers. The chapter offers the idea of *seasons*: choosing which value leads for a defined period, and reviewing it, rather than feeling permanently torn.

Everyday situations to develop. Saying health matters while going to bed at 1 a.m. every night; valuing creativity but having zero hours a week for it; valuing honesty but telling small lies to avoid conflict; spending on things mainly for how they look to others; saying yes to every family event and never to her own project.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Calendar and Bank Statement Audit:* one week of time and spending, read as evidence.
- *Values from Evidence:* the anger, admiration and "most myself" prompts.
- *The Values Filter:* one question for recurring decisions.
- *Choose Your Season:* which value leads for the next three months.

Takeaway. Her values are visible in her calendar and her spending. When the two don't match what she says matters, she can change the calendar, not just the speech.

Link to Chapter 4 (and to Part Two). Part One has given her clear wants, written standards and real values. Part Two is about building, starting with the word many women still hesitate to use about themselves: ambition.

Your story (optional). A decision you made from your values that other people didn't understand at the time.

Power Check

1. If a stranger read your last two weeks of calendar and spending, what would they say you value?

2. What makes you angry, and which value does that anger point to?
3. Which regular commitment in your week contradicts what you say matters most?

This week's move: Move One Hour. Go through the last seven days of your calendar and spending. Find one hour a week that goes to something that contradicts your values. This week, take that hour back and schedule it, in your calendar, for something that reflects one of your chosen values. Then protect it as you would a meeting with someone you respect.

PART TWO: BUILD IT

Ambition, discipline and money

Chapter 4: Ambition Looks Good on You

Planned length: 2,900 words

Objective and function. Reclaim ambition in its broadest sense, help the reader take her parked ideas off the shelf, and replace the overwhelming "five-year plan" with small, testable experiments. Ambition without hustle, and without needing to be anyone's idea of a "girlboss".

Belief to challenge. "Ambitious women are cold, selfish or intimidating." / "Ambition means a corner office, and that's not me."

Sections

1. **Ambition, redefined.** Ambition is wanting to grow something that matters to her: a career, a business, a craft, a qualification, a family, a community, a body of creative work. It doesn't have one shape and it doesn't have to be loud.
2. **The likeability trap.** The cultural script that says ambitious women are less likeable, and how it quietly shapes choices (playing down goals, avoiding visible effort). The chapter questions the script rather than quoting statistics, and offers a clear alternative: choosing respect over universal approval.
3. **The "someday" file.** Ideas parked indefinitely: the course, the business, the move, the book, the portfolio. Why "someday" feels safe (you can't fail at something you haven't started) and what it costs. Three honest options for every item: *date it, shrink it or drop it.* Dropping is allowed; pretending isn't.
4. **Goals as experiments.** Instead of a grand plan: a 90-day experiment with a clear question ("Will people pay for this?", "Do I actually enjoy this work?"), the smallest version she can test, and a review date. Failure becomes data rather than a verdict.
5. **Trying in public.** The fear of being seen trying, especially by people who knew her before. The first version will be imperfect; that's what first versions are for. How to handle the friends and relatives who don't understand.

6. **Ambition without burnout.** Why constant intensity isn't proof of commitment. Ambition that lasts is built around her life, health and responsibilities, not in spite of them.

Everyday situations to develop. A side project that has been "nearly ready" for two years; not applying for a promotion because she doesn't meet every requirement; hiding a small business from people she knows online; calling something "just a hobby" to avoid being judged; the family dinner where her plans get gently laughed at.

Tools and exercises.

- *Someday File Triage:* date it, shrink it or drop it.
- *The 90-Day Experiment sheet:* question, smallest version, success signs, review date.
- *The First Ugly Version:* deliberately making and sharing an imperfect first attempt.

Takeaway. Ambition is not a personality type. It's a decision to build something, and it can start very small.

Link to Chapter 5. Ambition starts things. Discipline is what keeps them going once the excitement fades.

Your story (optional). An ambition you held back for a long time, or something you started in public despite the fear.

Power Check

1. What's in your "someday" file, and how long has it been there?
2. What would your ambition look like if nobody could call you "too much"?
3. What's the smallest version of your biggest idea that you could test in the next 90 days?

This week's move: The First Ugly Version. Take one item from your "someday" file and define its smallest real version: one post, one pitch, one sample, one application, one conversation with a potential client. Produce it within seven days and show it to at least one person outside your closest circle. Note what you learned, not how good it was.

Chapter 5: Discipline Is Boring. Do It Anyway.

Planned length: 2,800 words

Objective and function. Give the reader systems for long-term goals: planning, routines, environment and review, so progress doesn't depend on motivation. This is discipline at scale, built for months, not days. Sustainable, realistic and explicitly not hustle culture.

Belief to challenge. "Disciplined people are just more motivated than me." / "I'll get going properly when I feel inspired."

Sections

1. **Motivation is a guest.** Motivation arrives with a new goal and leaves around week three. That's normal, not a sign she's chosen the wrong goal. Systems are what remain when motivation goes.
2. **Build the system.** A weekly planning session; fixed time blocks for the important thing; default routines that remove daily decisions. For each habit, two levels: a *minimum* (what she does even in her worst week) and an *ideal* (what she does when things go well).
3. **Design your environment.** Making the right thing easy and the wrong thing slightly awkward: the phone in another room, the bag packed the night before, the document already open, the app removed from the home screen. Environment does a lot of the work people credit to willpower.
4. **The boring middle.** The long stretch where nothing visible seems to happen. Tracking *actions* (sessions done, pitches sent, pages written) rather than only results, because actions are what she controls. A short monthly or quarterly review to adjust the plan.
5. **Discipline includes rest.** Planned rest, lighter weeks and different seasons of life. Health, work and caring responsibilities change what's realistic. Reducing the load on purpose is a strategy; quitting by default is not.

Everyday situations to develop. The big goal started in January with total enthusiasm and gone by March; studying for a qualification after work; training for a run; building a portfolio or a business on evenings and weekends; the Sunday-night dread of a week with no plan.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Weekly Power Hour:* a 30 to 60 minute planning ritual with a fixed agenda.
- *Minimum and Ideal:* two-level habit design.
- *The Environment Edit:* three changes that make the goal easier.
- *The Action Tracker:* counting what she did, not just what she got.

Takeaway. Discipline isn't a personality trait; it's a system. Build it once, adjust it often, and let it carry her through the boring middle.

Link to Chapter 6. Building anything eventually raises the question of money: earning it, asking for it and knowing where it goes.

Your story (optional). A routine or system that carried you through a long goal, and what you had to adjust to keep it going.

Power Check

1. Which goal have you started with enthusiasm more than once, and what usually happens in the middle?
2. What in your environment makes your goal harder than it needs to be?
3. What's the minimum version of your routine that you could keep even in your worst week?

This week's move: Install One System. Hold a 30-minute Weekly Power Hour this week. Choose one goal, define its minimum and ideal versions, block fixed times in your calendar for the next seven days, and make one change to your environment that makes the goal easier. At the end of the week, count how many blocks you kept. That number, not the result, is your score.

Chapter 6: Ask for the Money

Planned length: 3,000 words

Objective and function. Build money confidence: knowing her numbers, breaking the silence around money, researching her market value, negotiating pay and pricing her work. Money is treated as a skill and a form of self-respect, not a personality type. This chapter gives general principles only, not financial advice.

Belief to challenge. "I'm not a money person." / "Talking about money is rude or greedy." / "If I do good work, I'll be paid fairly."

Sections

1. **"I'm not a money person" is expensive.** Avoiding money doesn't make it less important; it just means decisions get made without her. Money is a skill anyone can learn. The starting point is a simple, judgement-free snapshot: what comes in, what goes out, what she saves and what she owes.
2. **The money silence.** Many families and friendship groups never talk about money, which makes it harder to know what's fair. How to start money conversations with trusted peers (what they earn, what they charge, how they negotiated) and why sharing information helps everyone.
3. **Know your number.** How to research her market value: job listings, professional associations, published salary surveys, peers in the same field. For freelancers and business owners: pricing based on time, costs and the value delivered, not on guilt or on being "new". The problem of always being the first to name a low number.
4. **The ask.** A simple negotiation structure: *Number, Reason, Pause.* She states her number, gives one or two reasons, and then stops talking. Handling common replies ("There's no budget right now", "That's above our range"). Negotiating beyond salary: title, flexibility, training, review dates. Rehearsing out loud. Accepting, countering or walking away deliberately rather than in a panic.
5. **Money and relationships.** Splitting costs with friends and partners; lending money; keeping some financial independence in a relationship; group plans she can't afford. Applying her standards (Chapter 2) to money.

A short note within the chapter makes clear that it offers general principles, and that investing, debt, tax and major financial decisions deserve advice from a qualified professional.

Everyday situations to develop. Accepting the first offer; undercharging freelance work "because I'm still learning"; never opening the banking app; the awkward moment

of splitting a restaurant bill; a partner managing all the household finances; an expensive birthday trip she agrees to and can't afford.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Money Snapshot:* a one-page overview, no judgement.
- *The Rate Research checklist:* where to look and what to note.
- *Number, Reason, Pause:* the ask script, with variations for employees and freelancers.
- *Rehearse Out Loud:* practising the ask with a friend or a voice recording.

Takeaway. Money confidence isn't about how much she has; it's about knowing her numbers and being willing to ask. Not asking is also a decision, and usually the most expensive one.

Link to Chapter 7 (and to Part Three). Pay is one way she's valued. Visibility is another. Part Three is about showing up, starting with how much space she takes in the rooms that matter.

Your story (optional). The first time you negotiated, raised your prices or had an honest conversation about money. Share only what you're comfortable with; no figures are needed.

Power Check

1. Do you know, without checking, roughly what you earn, spend and save each month?
2. When did you last accept a number without asking whether it could be higher?
3. Which money conversation are you avoiding, and with whom?

This week's move: One Money Conversation. Complete your Money Snapshot. Then have one money conversation you've been avoiding: ask a trusted peer what they earn or charge, raise your rate for your next client, request a pay review meeting, or talk to your partner about how you share costs. Prepare it with Number, Reason, Pause, and write down what happened afterwards.

PART THREE: SHOW IT

Presence, relationships and the people around you

Chapter 7: Take Up Space on Purpose

Planned length: 3,000 words

Objective and function. Help the reader become visible: making her work known, speaking with authority, taking credit, leading before she has the title, and presenting

herself as a deliberate choice. It also addresses the feedback many visible women receive ("too much", "intimidating") and how to tell real feedback from discomfort.

Belief to challenge. "Good work speaks for itself." / "Taking credit is bragging." / "If I'm too visible, I'll be judged."

Sections

1. **Good work doesn't speak.** Decisions about promotions, clients and opportunities are made by people who know what she's done. Making her work visible: short progress updates, sharing results, letting the right people know what she's working on.
2. **Speak like you mean it.** Practical habits for meetings and group settings: contributing early, finishing sentences without qualifiers, stating a view before asking for opinions. Calm lines for interruptions ("I'd like to finish my point") and for when someone repeats her idea ("Thanks for building on what I said earlier").
3. **Taking credit without cringing.** Using "I" for her own work and "we" for shared work; describing wins as facts, not boasts; keeping a "brag file" of achievements so she doesn't have to remember them under pressure; sharing her work online without apologising for it.
4. **Lead before you're given the title.** Leadership as behaviour: making decisions, taking initiative, giving useful feedback, owning mistakes cleanly and making room for others to speak.
5. **Presence is a choice.** Self-presentation (style, voice, how she enters a room, how she shows up online) as a form of expression she controls, not a test she has to pass. There's no required look for power; there's only what feels deliberately hers.
6. **"Too much" and "intimidating".** When she becomes more visible, some feedback will follow. How to separate useful feedback about behaviour (for example, regularly talking over others) from discomfort with a woman being seen. The key question: "Can you give me a specific example?"

Everyday situations to develop. A colleague presenting her idea as their own; saying "we" about work she did alone; not posting about her own launch; being talked over in a meeting; hearing "You've changed" from an old friend; avoiding a presentation or a panel invitation.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Brag File:* a running record of achievements, feedback and results.
- *Interruption and Credit lines:* short, calm phrases for common moments.
- *The Three-Sentence Win:* what I did, the result, what's next.
- *"Specifics, please":* how to respond to vague feedback about being "too much".

Takeaway. Visibility isn't vanity. If the people who matter for her goals don't know what she does, it's as if she hadn't done it.

Link to Chapter 8. Being more visible changes who notices her, including romantically. Next: choosing who gets close.

Your story (optional). A moment you took up space and it paid off, or one that felt uncomfortable but turned out to be right.

Power Check

1. What have you achieved in the last six months that the people who matter for your goals don't know about?
2. In which room do you still make yourself smaller than you are?
3. When someone calls you "too much", what exactly are they describing?

This week's move: Make One Win Visible. Start your Brag File with at least five entries. Then share one win this week with someone who influences your goals (a manager, a client, a community, your audience) using the Three-Sentence Win. In at least one meeting or group conversation this week, speak within the first ten minutes.

Chapter 8: Date Like You Have Options (Because You Do)

Planned length: 3,000 words

Objective and function. Help the reader date deliberately: knowing what she's choosing, treating dates as a mutual decision rather than an audition, telling chemistry from compatibility, and keeping her own life intact while dating. Book 1 dealt with leaving ambiguous situations; this chapter is about choosing well from the start.

Belief to challenge. "I should be grateful someone is interested." / "Chemistry is the best sign." / "If I'm picky, I'll end up alone."

Sections

1. **From audition to selection.** On many dates, she spends the evening wondering whether they like her. The shift: being curious about whether *she* likes *them*, and whether they meet her standards. Both people are deciding; she's allowed to be one of them.
2. **Know what you're choosing.** Relationship standards based on behaviour and values (consistency, kindness, how someone handles disagreement, respect for her time and ambitions), not checklists of height, job or income. Sorting into *dealbreakers*, *important* and *nice extras*.
3. **Chemistry isn't a compatibility test.** Strong attraction can come from familiarity, including familiarity with patterns she doesn't want to repeat. Taking time before deciding; noticing how someone treats people who can't do anything for them.
4. **Early signals worth noticing.** Respect shows up early: following through on plans, curiosity about her life, how they react to a small no, how they talk about other people. These signals are more reliable than grand gestures.
5. **Dating with a full life.** Keeping her friendships, goals, routines and plans while dating, rather than clearing her life to make room for someone she's known for two weeks.

6. **Single, with standards.** Being single is a valid state, not a waiting room. Choosing not to date for a while can itself be a deliberate decision.

The chapter uses neutral language ("the person you're dating") so every reader can see herself in it, and includes a brief, serious note that controlling or frightening behaviour is not a "red flag to work on" but a reason to seek support.

Everyday situations to develop. A first date where she learns everything about them and they learn nothing about her; swiping on everyone to feel wanted; overlooking that they were rude to the waiter; dropping her gym routine two weeks into seeing someone; relatives calling her "too picky".

Tools and exercises.

- *The Relationship Standards Card:* dealbreakers, important, nice extras.
- *The Post-Date Debrief:* three questions within 24 hours.
- *The Small No Test:* noticing how someone responds to a minor refusal.
- *The Full-Life Rule:* the commitments she keeps no matter how exciting things get.

Takeaway. Being chosen feels good. Choosing is power. She decides who gets close, based on what they do over time.

Link to Chapter 9. Choosing well is half of it. The other half is keeping her standards alive in relationships that have lasted for years.

Your story (optional). What changed when you stopped auditioning and started choosing. Entirely optional; the chapter works fully with hypothetical scenarios.

Power Check

1. Which three behaviours would someone need to show consistently for you to feel respected?
2. After your last few dates, did you spend more time wondering whether they liked you, or whether you liked them?
3. Which part of your life do you usually shrink when you start seeing someone?

This week's move: The Post-Date Debrief. Write your Relationship Standards Card. After every date or meaningful interaction this week, answer three questions within 24 hours: How did I feel during and after? What did they actually do, not just say? Does this match my card? Decide your next step from the card, not from nerves. If you're not dating, review your most recent relationship against the card and note what you'd do differently.

Chapter 9: Standards Don't Expire When You Get Comfortable

Planned length: 2,800 words

Objective and function. Help the reader keep and renegotiate her standards in long-standing relationships: with a partner, family and old friends. It covers asking for what she needs, handling conflict constructively, changing old arrangements and repairing after a disagreement.

Belief to challenge. "Conflict means something's wrong with the relationship." / "It's too late to change how things work between us."

Sections

1. **Comfort creep.** How standards slip in long relationships: an unequal share of the planning and housework, a tone that's become normal, being taken for granted, roles that made sense years ago.
2. **Conflict is maintenance.** Healthy conflict (addressing a topic) versus fighting (attacking a person). Choosing the right moment; one issue at a time; aiming for a solution rather than a win.
3. **Ask, don't hint.** Hints, tests and silent scorekeeping rarely work. A simple request formula: what she noticed, what she needs, and a specific request ("Would you be willing to…?").
4. **Renegotiating old deals.** Many relationships run on arrangements from the past: the daughter who always hosts, the partner who handles "the money", the friend who always chooses the plans. A respectful way to say "This worked before; it doesn't work for me now", and to propose a new arrangement for a trial period.
5. **Repair.** A real apology for real harm (different from the automatic apologising many women are trying to stop): naming what happened, taking responsibility, changing the behaviour. Receiving apologies, and moving on without keeping a file.
6. **When a standard can't be met.** Some people can't or won't change. Accepting limits, adjusting closeness and choosing what kind of relationship is still possible. A clear note that these tools assume a safe relationship; abuse is not a communication problem, and support is available.

Everyday situations to develop. Being the one who plans every holiday, birthday and shopping list; a parent who still treats her like a teenager; an old friend whose jokes at her expense have gone on for years; a partner who dismisses her career plans; the same argument every month about the same thing.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Request Formula:* "I've noticed… I need… Would you be willing to…?"
- *The Old Deal Renegotiation:* a script and a trial-period structure.
- *The Repair Checklist:* for apologising and for receiving apologies.
- *The Monthly Check-In:* a short, regular "how are we doing?" conversation for couples or close relationships.

Takeaway. Long relationships need maintenance, not silence. She can update the terms of a relationship without ending it.

Link to Chapter 10. The final piece is the wider circle around her: the friends, mentors and communities that shape what she thinks is normal.

Your story (optional). A relationship in which you successfully renegotiated something. Share only what feels comfortable, and nothing that identifies the other person.

Power Check

1. Which relationship in your life still runs on an arrangement you no longer agree with?
2. What do you hint at instead of asking for directly?
3. After a disagreement, do you usually repair, avoid or keep score?

This week's move: Renegotiate One Deal. Choose one recurring arrangement that no longer works for you: how chores are shared, the weekly family call, the friend who always chooses the plans. Write your request using the Request Formula. Have the conversation this week at a calm moment, not in the middle of an argument. Agree to try the new arrangement for two to four weeks, and set a date to review it together.

Chapter 10: Build a Circle That Raises the Bar

Planned length: 2,600 words

Objective and function. Help the reader shape her circle deliberately: setting friendship standards, finding women further along the path she wants, becoming that woman for others and letting some friendships change shape without drama. It completes the book's arc by connecting personal power to the people around her.

Belief to challenge. "Friendships should just happen naturally." / "Asking someone to mentor me is asking for a favour I haven't earned."

Sections

1. **Your circle is your environment.** The people around her shape what she thinks is normal: what she earns, what she attempts, how she's treated. A gentle audit of who energises her and who stretches her, without coldly ranking friends.
2. **Friendship standards.** What she gives and what she expects: reciprocity, honesty, showing up, being genuinely happy for each other. Being that kind of friend first.
3. **Find women further ahead.** How to approach someone who is doing what she wants to do: a specific question rather than "Can I pick your brain?", respecting their time, offering something in return, following up with what she did with their advice. Where to find them: professional groups, courses, local communities, online spaces.
4. **Be the woman further ahead.** Power grows when it's shared. Sharing information (rates, opportunities, contacts), recommending other women, helping someone who's a step behind. A natural extension of everything in the book.

5. **Outgrowing without burning bridges.** Some friendships will change as she changes. Letting a friendship become less central without a dramatic exit or a public "cut-off"; recognising seasons; staying kind.

Everyday situations to develop. A group chat that's mostly complaining; a friend who goes quiet whenever she shares good news; nobody in her network has done what she wants to do; being afraid to message someone she admires; feeling lonely after moving to a new city.

Tools and exercises.

- *The Circle Map:* who energises, who stretches, who drains.
- *The Mentor Message:* a short template for approaching someone further ahead.
- *Share It Forward:* one piece of useful information or one introduction a week.

Takeaway. Her circle is part of her power. She can choose it, grow it and pass it on.

Link to the conclusion. She now has the full set: clear wants, written standards, real values, systems, money confidence, visibility and a circle that supports her. The conclusion turns them into one plan.

Your story (optional). A woman who helped you move forward, or someone you helped. No names or identifying details are needed.

Power Check

1. Who in your life celebrates your wins as loudly as their own?
2. Who is doing what you want to do, and what's one specific question you'd ask them?
3. What kind of friend are you being to the women around you who are a step behind?

This week's move: One Up, One Down. Send one message to someone further along the path you want, using the Mentor Message template, with one specific question. Then offer one concrete piece of help, information or an introduction to someone a step behind you. Finally, make one plan with a friend who raises the bar.

Conclusion: Let It Show

Planned length: 2,000 words

Objective and function. Bring the book together, show the reader how much of her life she has moved from default to chosen, give her a plan she can keep updating, and close both the book and the series with a strong, satisfying ending. Readers who started here should feel complete; readers who've read both books should feel the series has come full circle.

Sections

1. **What you built.** A short, punchy recap of the ten moves: from vague wishes to clear wants; from "fine" to written standards; from "someday" to experiments; from

hoping to asking; from silence to visibility; from being chosen to choosing.

2. **Retake the Default Audit.** She returns to the eight areas from the introduction and compares. The aim isn't for everything to be "chosen"; it's to see where she has moved, and where she wants to go next.
3. **Your Power Plan.** A one-page plan: her top one to three wants; her five standards; her three or four values; her current system; one money move; one visibility habit; the people in her circle who support her; and the date of her next review.
4. **When your power dips.** Tiredness, criticism, setbacks and big changes will knock her off course. That's normal. A simple routine for those moments: go back to the minimum version of the system, reread her standards, write one Pre-Decision for the next difficult moment, and contact one person in her circle. If old insecure habits come back, she can notice them, name the fear behind them and choose a slightly braver step, as introduced at the start of this book.
5. **Let it show.** A closing message in the book's voice: power isn't something she waits to be given. It's something she practises, and other people can see it. For readers who started here, a single line mentions that *Your Insecurity Is Showing* explores the habits that keep women small, if they want to go back to the beginning.

Takeaway. Her life is no longer something that happens to her by default. She decides, builds and shows up on purpose, and she has a plan for keeping it that way.

Your story (optional). A few closing words from you to the reader at the end of the series.

Final Power Check

1. Which area of your life has moved furthest from "default" to "chosen"?
2. Which standard was hardest to keep, and what will help next time?
3. What do you want next? Answer in one sentence that starts with "I want".

Final move: The Quarterly Power Review. Complete your Power Plan. Make your first move from it within 72 hours. Then set a recurring calendar appointment every three months called "Power Review". At each review, retake the Default Audit, update your plan and choose your next move.

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5. Power Checks: summary of the weekly moves

Each move targets a specific area and uses a different type of exercise. Compared with Book 1's Reality Checks, which mostly helped the reader notice and interrupt habits, Book 2's moves are about deciding, asking, building and making things visible.

Chapter	Move	Type of exercise	What it builds
Intro	The Default Audit	Baseline self-assessment	Awareness of drift
1	Say It in One Sentence	Spoken declaration	Clear, owned wants
2	Pre-Decide One Moment	Advance decision + review	Standards in action
3	Move One Hour	Time audit + calendar change	Values-aligned choices
4	The First Ugly Version	Rapid prototype + sharing	Ambition in motion
5	Install One System	Planning ritual + environment change	Consistent progress
6	One Money Conversation	Financial snapshot + real negotiation or talk	Money confidence
7	Make One Win Visible	Brag file + structured self-promotion	Visibility and presence
8	The Post-Date Debrief	Written criteria + structured reflection	Deliberate choice of partners
9	Renegotiate One Deal	Prepared conversation + trial period	Healthier long-term relationships
10	One Up, One Down	Outreach + giving back	A supportive circle
Concl.	The Quarterly Power Review	Personal plan + recurring review	Lasting direction

6. Word plan

The counts below refer to the future manuscript (body text only, including each chapter's Power Check). Front and back matter (title page, copyright, contents, acknowledgements, author bio, any promotional pages) are not counted.

Section	Title	Planned words
Introduction	You Stopped Shrinking. Now What?	2,000
Chapter 1	Wanting More Is Not a Character Flaw	2,800
Chapter 2	Standards Are Not a Wish List	3,000
Chapter 3	Your Calendar Knows What You Value	2,600
Chapter 4	Ambition Looks Good on You	2,900
Chapter 5	Discipline Is Boring. Do It Anyway.	2,800
Chapter 6	Ask for the Money	3,000
Chapter 7	Take Up Space on Purpose	3,000
Chapter 8	Date Like You Have Options (Because You Do)	3,000
Chapter 9	Standards Don't Expire When You Get Comfortable	2,800
Chapter 10	Build a Circle That Raises the Bar	2,600
Conclusion	Let It Show	2,000
Total		**32,500**

By part: Introduction 2,000 · Part One 8,400 · Part Two 8,700 · Part Three 11,400 · Conclusion 2,000.

Notes on the plan

- The total of **32,500 words** is comfortably above the agreed **minimum of 30,000**, leaving room for normal tightening during editing.
- Chapter lengths may vary by about 10% either way as the writing develops, but the manuscript total will not fall below 30,000 words.
- The longest chapters (3,000 words) are those that carry the most scripts and step-by-step methods: standards and the Pre-Decision (2), money (6), visibility (7) and dating (8).
- Part Three is the longest part because it covers four distinct relationship areas (professional presence, dating, long-term relationships, wider circle), each with its own tools.
- Each chapter's Power Check accounts for roughly 200 to 300 words of its total.
- No chapter is padded to reach the target. If a chapter runs short, the extra words go into worked examples and scripts.
- At a similar length to Book 1 (32,400 words), the two books will feel like a matched pair on the shelf and in the reader's hands.

7. How Book 2 fits with Book 1

The distinction

	Book 1: *Your Insecurity Is Showing*	Book 2: *Your Power Is Showing*
Core question	"What am I doing out of fear?"	"What do I want, and what am I building?"
Problem tackled	Insecurity making her decisions	Drift: life running on default
Direction	Subtraction: stop the habits that keep her small	Addition: build standards, ambition and relationships on purpose
Signature tool	The Tell Check: Spot, Story, Cost, Trade (in or after the moment)	The Pre-Decision: Want, Line, Move, Review (before the moment)
End-of-chapter feature	Reality Check: three questions, one action	Power Check: three questions, one move
Opening and closing exercise	The Tell Inventory	The Default Audit
Personal plan at the end	The Tell Map and the bad-day plan	The Power Plan and the quarterly review
Voice	The mirror	The coach

Topic by topic: no repetition

Where both books touch the same subject, each takes a different angle. This table shows exactly where the line falls, so both manuscripts can be written in parallel without overlap.

Topic	Book 1 (chapter)	Book 2 (chapter)
Saying no / standards	Catching the yes reflex; holding a no under pressure (Ch. 5, 8)	Defining what she chooses and expects, in advance, across five life areas (Ch. 2)
Discipline	Tiny kept promises to rebuild self-trust (Ch. 9)	Systems, environment and review for long-term goals (Ch. 5)
Validation and self-respect	Ending reassurance loops; self-approval without an audience (Ch. 3, 10)	Values identified from evidence; self-respect as daily practice (Ch. 3)
Work	Staying quiet, invisible tasks, over-apologising at work (Ch. 5)	Ambition (Ch. 4), negotiation and pricing (Ch. 6), visibility, credit and leadership (Ch. 7)
Money	Not covered beyond a brief mention	Full chapter: numbers, conversations, negotiation (Ch. 6)

Topic	Book 1 (chapter)	Book 2 (chapter)
Dating	Stopping situationships, asking the clear question, leaving cleanly (Ch. 6)	Choosing partners deliberately; chemistry versus compatibility (Ch. 8)
Long-term relationships and family	Family roles as a source of people-pleasing (Ch. 5)	Renegotiating old arrangements, healthy conflict, repair (Ch. 9)
Other women	Interrupting comparison and decoding envy (Ch. 4)	Friendship standards, mentors, sharing power forward (Ch. 10)
Appearance and presence	Stopping appearance anxiety from making decisions (Ch. 7)	Presence and self-presentation as deliberate expression (Ch. 7)
Overthinking and decisions	Breaking loops; pencil and pen decisions (Ch. 2)	Deciding in advance with the Pre-Decision (Ch. 2)
Apologising	Stopping unnecessary apologies (Ch. 5)	Making a real apology for real harm, as part of repair (Ch. 9)

How Book 2 stands on its own

- **No required reading.** The introduction includes a short section for readers who start here, with one self-contained tip for moments when old insecure habits flare up. Nothing later depends on Book 1's tools.
- **No repeated material.** Book 2 does not reteach the Tell Check, the Tell Inventory or any Book 1 exercise. When the two books touch the same theme, Book 2 takes the "build" angle shown in the table above.
- **Light, optional references.** Book 2 can mention Book 1 briefly (in the introduction and once in the conclusion) for readers who want to go deeper into the habits that keep women small. These references are never needed to understand or use Book 2.
- **A satisfying series ending.** The conclusion closes Book 2 completely and also gives readers of both books a sense of a finished journey: from catching what keeps them small to choosing what makes them powerful.

8. Points for your review

To finalise the outline before writing begins, it would help to have your thoughts on the following:

1. **Subtitle.** Do you prefer the recommended subtitle or one of the alternatives? Should the two subtitles mirror each other more closely?
2. **Names of the tools.** Are you happy with "the Pre-Decision" as Book 2's signature tool and "Power Check" as the end-of-chapter feature?
3. **Chapter order and titles.** Are you happy with the Decide it / Build it / Show it structure and the chapter titles?
4. **The money chapter.** How personal would you like this chapter to be? It works without any of your own figures; a short story about a first negotiation or a price rise would make it stronger if you're comfortable sharing one.
5. **Personal stories.** Which of the optional "Your story" prompts would you like to contribute to? Short notes or voice memos are enough to start from.
6. **Topics to keep hypothetical.** Are there areas (for example dating, family or money) that you'd prefer to keep fully hypothetical?
7. **Consistency across the series.** Any choices you make for Book 1 (spelling, how you address the reader, a signature touch such as Dutch-style directness) will be applied to Book 2 as well. Please let us know if you'd like Book 2 to differ on any of these.